



#TEACHLIKETHEPLANETMATTERS

Sustainability Education and Teacher Positionality

Our collective responsibility to teach like the planet matters!!

Sophie Wilson

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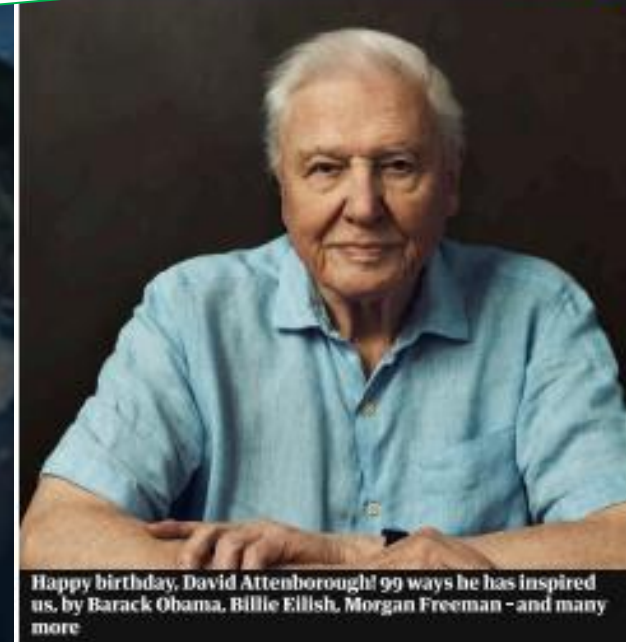
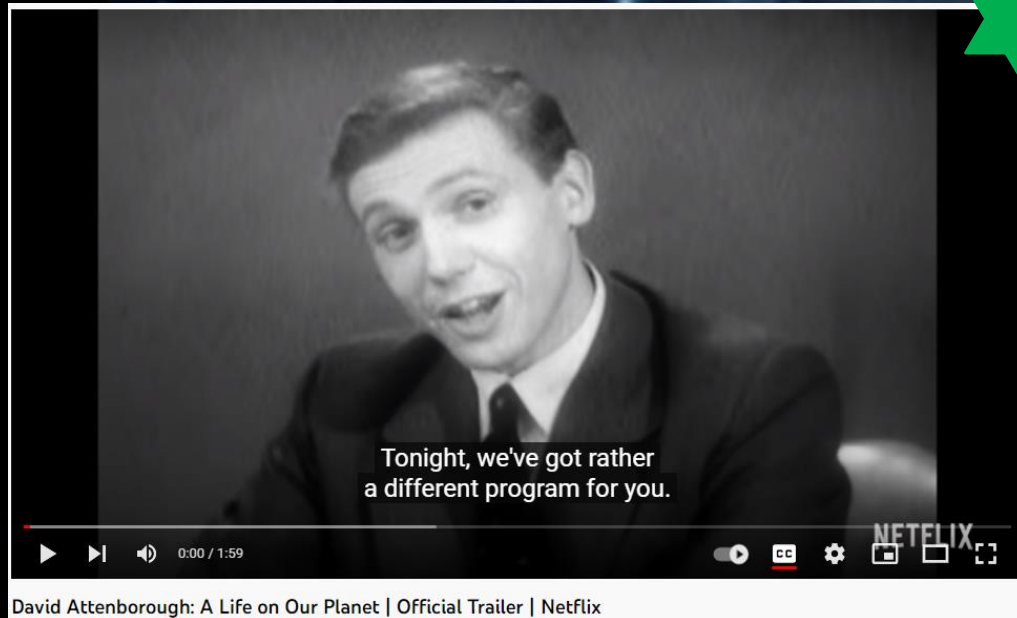
DfE finalises its climate change strategy: What schools need to know

SCHOOLS
WEEK

Every school will have a climate lead, and 'sustainable' tests will be developed

April 2022

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This week the presenter turns 99. To celebrate, we asked 99 nature lovers - including Margaret Atwood, Jane Fonda, Bono, Kate Winslet and Michael Palin - how he has helped us see the world with fresh eyes

Sustainability Education

Earthrise: how the iconic image changed the world



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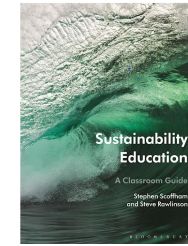


📷 The Earth rises into view over the lunar horizon for the astronauts aboard Apollo 8 in 1968. Photograph: Corbis/Getty Images

Apollo 8 astronaut Bill Anders talks about Nasa's orbit 50 years ago when he photographed Earth as it had never been seen before

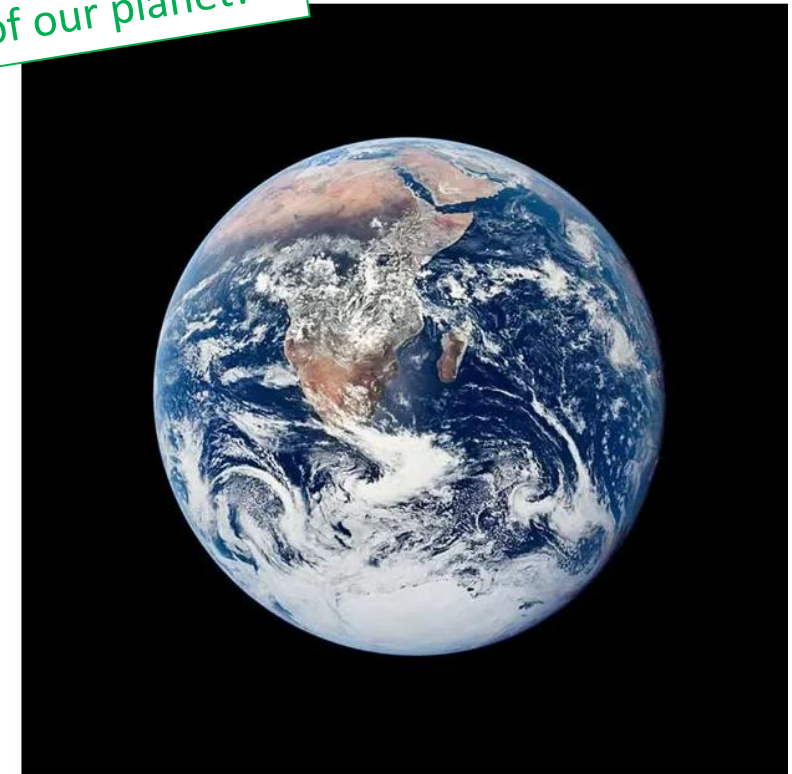
Most viewed

'We came all this way to explore the moon, and the most important thing is that we discovered the Earth'!
Bill Anders



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Fragility of our planet!



📷 An image of the planet taken by Apollo 17, on 7 December 1972, released by Nasa to celebrate Earth Day. Photograph: Nasa/Reuters

'Blue Marble' Apollo 17, 7 Dec 1972: Nasa/Reuters



Policy paper

Sustainability and climate change: a strategy for the education and children's services systems

Published 21 April 2022

Contents

Scope and purpose

Foreword

Context

The challenge and the opportunity

Vision and aims

Initiatives to drive the strategy

Action area 1: Climate education

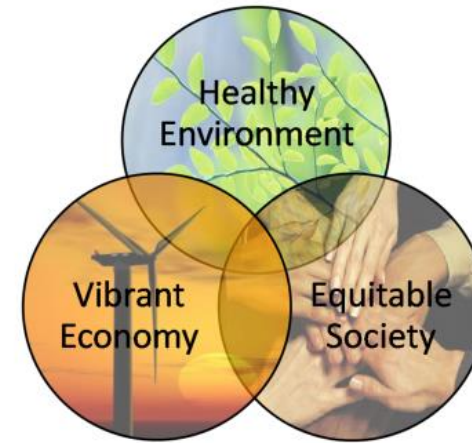
Action area 2: Green skills and careers

Action area 3: Education estate and digital infrastructure

Action area 4: Operations and supply chains

Action area 5: International

Leadership, engagement and next steps



25 Year Environmental Plan and
Net Zero Strategy.....

Build back Greener.....

Initiatives = A whole systems approach
driven by:

- ☐ National Education Nature Park
- ☐ Climate Leaders Award
- ☐ Sustainability leadership

Integrate Sustainability Education into the taught
curriculum

What was included...

Now 2025!

1. New natural history GCSE
2. Every school to have 'sustainability' lead ...
3. ... and they'll get carbon literacy training
4. Schools to report emissions by 2024
5. DfE to develop 'sustainable tests'.
6. Annual climate literacy survey
7. 'Let's Go Zero' targets for schools
8. No more single-use plastics
9. Annual progress reports



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Sustainability Education

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Department
for Education

Updated December 2023

Policy paper

**Sustainability and climate change: a
strategy for the education and children's
services systems**

Updated 20 December 2023



Policy paper

Sustainability and climate change: a strategy for the education and children's services systems

Updated 20 December 2023

Applies to England

Contents

Scope and purpose

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Action area 4: Operations and supply chains

Action area 5: International

Leadership, engagement and next steps



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Vision and aims

Vision: the United Kingdom is the **world-leading education sector** in sustainability and climate change by 2030.

In England, we will achieve this through the following strategic aims:

1. Excellence in **education and skills for a changing world**: preparing all young people for a world impacted by climate change through learning and practical experience.
2. **Net zero**: reducing direct and indirect emissions from education and care buildings, driving innovation to meet legislative targets and providing opportunities for children and young people to engage practically in the transition to net zero.
3. **Resilience to climate change**: adapting our education and care buildings and system to prepare for the effects of climate change.
4. **A better environment for future generations**: enhancing biodiversity, improving air quality and increasing access to, and connection with, nature in and around education and care settings.

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The Climate Ambassadors programme is all about providing expert support

 [Climate change](#)

United Nations • Climate change refers to long-term shifts in temperatures and weather patterns. Human activity, such as burning of fossil fuels like coal, oil and gas, is the main cause of climate change.

Sustainability experts needed for national education scheme

 **National Education Nature Park**

[Home](#) [Learn more](#) [Resources](#) [News and events](#)



How the Nature Park works

By taking part in the Nature Park, young people will lead the way following a five-step cycle which can be built upon year on year

The National Education Nature Park programme aims to embed nature-based learning in the curriculum, and encourage children and young people all over the country to take action to improve their site for people and wildlife.

The programme provides the support and guidance needed to make this happen, with five key steps in the journey and the actions needed to reach your goals.



CLIMATE AMBASSADOR TRAINING

Date: Tuesday 11th March 2025

Time: 1:30pm to 4:30pm

Venue: St Mary's University, Twickenham. TW1 4

Become a Climate Ambassador

Empower Your Education Setting to Take Climate Action

Are you an ECT, PGCE student, or School Mentor connected to St Mary's University? Join us for in-person training designed to equip you with the tools and knowledge to drive the creation and delivery of a **Climate Action Plan** for your education setting.

This training will focus on building a 'whole school approach' to climate action, ensuring

[Book your free place](#)

Browse by Key Stage

Find resources for different ages of learners

 **EYFS**

 **KS1**

 **KS4**

 **KS5**

Browse by Subject

Find resources for a range of subjects – to filter by Early Learning Goals, or the key stage section above

 **Art and design**

 **Biology**

 **Chemistry**

 **Citizenship**

 **Computing**

 **Design and technology**

 **English**

 **Geography**

 **Maths**

 **Music**

 **Physics**

 **Science (<KS2)**

Explore the Nature Park

Browse curated selections of activities and guidance to explore a theme or goal on your Nature Park journey

 **Getting started**

 **Nature connection**

 **Explore your school site**

 **Your nature data**

 **St Mary's University Twickenham London School of Education**

Sustainability Support for Education

[Home](#) [About](#) [Guidance](#) [Saved](#)

Explore what your setting can do

Find recommended actions for your setting to become more sustainable, or to shape your Climate Action Plan. To help you complete the actions, we quality assure resources you can use for support.

1. Sustainability journey

Find aims that are suitable for your setting, based on what you've done so far.

2. Setting the groundwork

[View this stage >](#)

3. Taking the first steps

[View this stage >](#)

4. Developing your practice

[View this stage >](#)

5. Learning to lead

[View this stage >](#)

A Whole Systems Approach

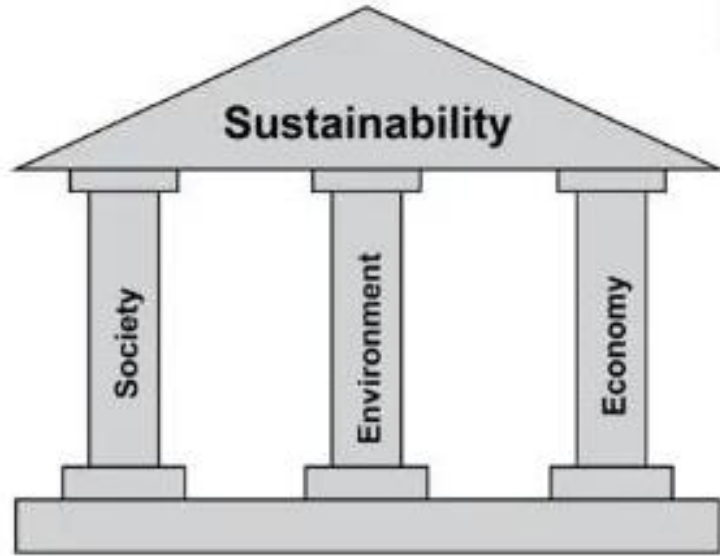


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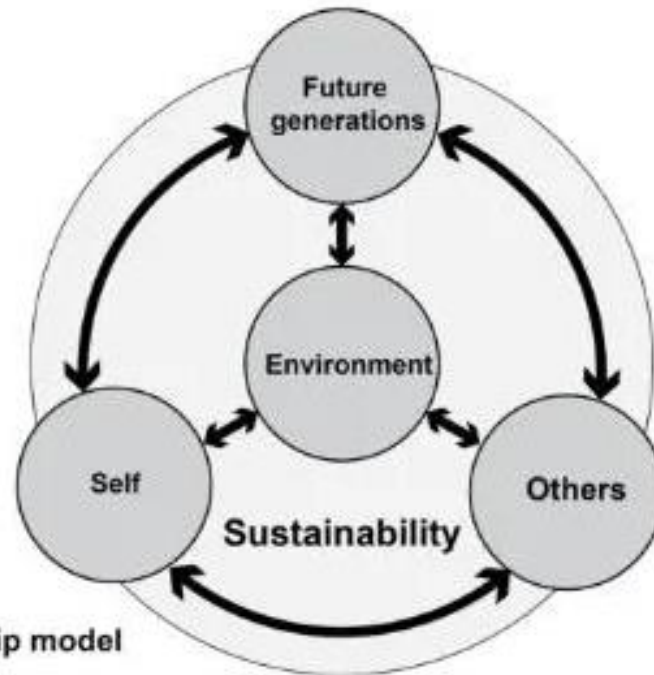
Defining sustainability

Fragility of our planet!

Definitions of Sustainability



The three pillars model



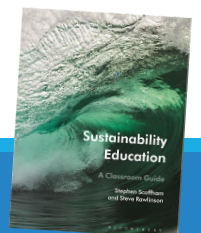
The inter-relationship model

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The idea of

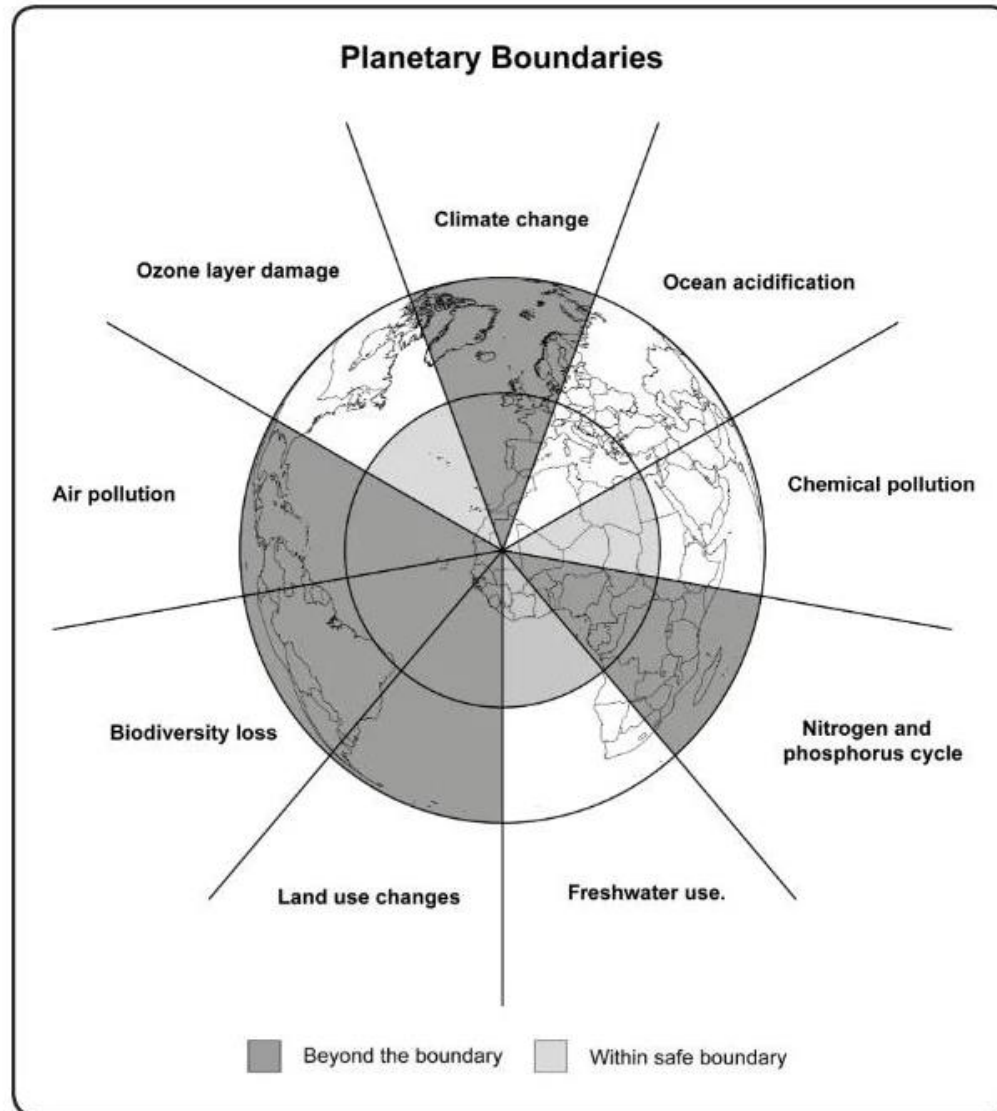
- ❑ 'reconnecting' is important
- ❑ pupils can explore both their inner selves and their **role in, and responsibility** for, the **planet** that supports them.

Need for stewardship..



Planetary boundaries

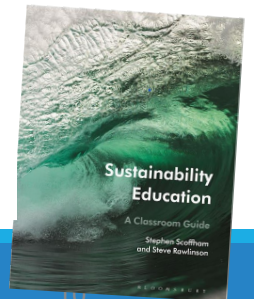
Fragility of our planet!



Some key planetary boundaries have already been breached, risking irreversible change, while others are only just within the safe boundary. After *Rockström and Klum 2015* and *Raworth 2017*.

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Need for stewardship..



The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) (2015)

valuable framework for this vision for education- Target 4.7.

'By 2030, ensure **all learners acquire knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development,**



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Sustainability Education and subject disciplines

A classroom guide

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Sustainability Education

A Classroom Guide

Stephen Scoffham
and Steve Rawlinson

BLOOMSBURY

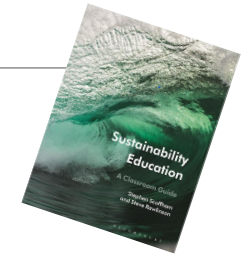
Fragility of our planet!

Curriculum Subject Grid

Subject	Earth in Space (Chapt 6)	Life on Land (Chapt 7)	A Wet Planet (Chapt 8)	Weather & Climate (Chapt 9)	Food & Farming (Chapt 10)	Jobs, Transport & Energy (Chapt 11)	The Global Village (Chapt 12)	Special Places (Chapt 13)	Citizenship & Democracy (Chapt 14)	Pollution & Conservation (Chapt 15)	Unequal World (Chapt 16)	Sustainable Living (Chapt 17)
Art	X	X	X					X		X	X	X
Citizenship				X		X				X	X	
Design/technology		X		X			X	X		X		
Drama	X	X	X		X	X			X	X	X	X
English	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
Geography	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
History			X			X	X	X			X	
Mathematics		X			X		X			X	X	X
Music	X			X					X			
Religious Education	X			X				X	X			X
Science	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X		

A way of thinking...

- MFL – appreciation of **cultural diversity**
- PE - importance of **environmental health** and **individual well being/fitness benefits** - our connection with **nature + outdoors – Sport...ENGLAND**



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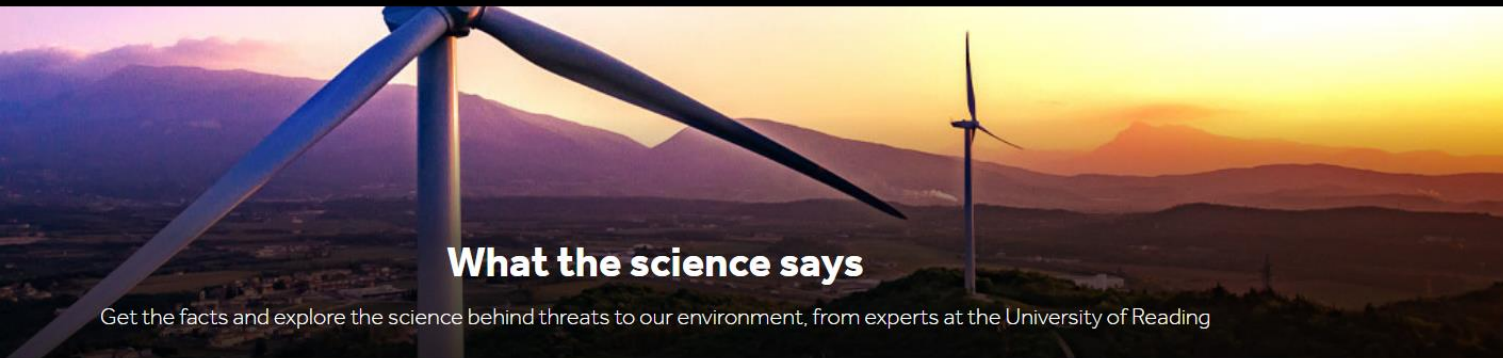
Fragility of our planet!
Importance of **subject lenses**
– not an added extra....
but a **way of thinking...** as
stewards of our natural world...

YOUR
TURN!

*IMPORTANT QUESTIONS?
What do YOU think...*

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- ☐ What is our **positioning** as teachers?
- ☐ What is **our responsibility** as educators in developing climate education?
- ☐ Why does this **need coverage** in schools?
- ☐ How can we **inform** this change?
- ☐ What **support do we need to become change makers?**



What the science says

Get the facts and explore the science behind threats to our environment, from experts at the University of Reading

IPCC involvement

The **Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC)** published its latest major report into the impacts of climate change on the planet in August 2021. As the United Nations body for assessing the science related to climate change, it provides policymakers with regular assessments, information on future risks, and options for mitigation and adaptation.

Six scientists from Reading's Department of Meteorology were lead authors in the first Working Group report –



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The issue of climate change

- Why do the Paris Agreement targets matter?
- Who is the most affected by climate change?
- Which areas of the world are hardest hit by climate change?



Atmosphere and weather

- Why is more hot weather such a big problem?
- Are heatwaves a result of climate change?
- How can climate warming bring cold weather too?
- Is preventing global temperature rise realistic?
- Will climate change affect winter weather too?



Climate change and society

- Is tackling climate change up to individuals or society as a whole?
- How will climate change affect my travel?
- How is climate change impacting farmers?
- What does 'pre-industrial climate' mean?



The ecosystem and biodiversity

- Are we already losing plants and wildlife to climate change?
- What impact would biodiversity loss have on us?
- How is climate change affecting wildlife?
- Will geoengineering solve the problem?



Sea levels and flooding

- What will Arctic ice melting look like in real life?
- How will the Antarctic be affected by climate change?
- Can we cope with rising sea levels?
- Does climate change result in increased flooding?



Climate action and solutions

- What positive action has been taken on climate change so far?
- How could society change to reduce emissions?
- Is renewable energy an easy fix?
- How can I reduce my carbon footprint?
- Can we plant trees to combat climate change?

Climate stripes

Representing global temperature rise over two centuries

Show Your Stripes Day – 21 June

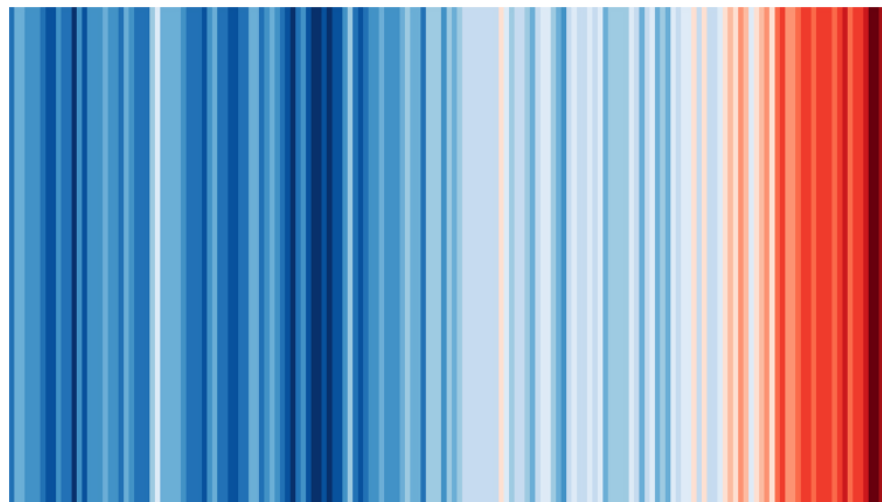
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What are the stripes?

No words. No numbers. No graphs. Just a series of vertical coloured bars, showing the progressive heating of our planet in a single, striking image.

The climate stripes were **created by Professor Ed Hawkins** at the University of Reading in 2018.

They show clearly and vividly how global average temperatures have risen over nearly two centuries,



How do they work?

Each stripe represents the average temperature for a single year, relative to the average temperature over the period as a whole. Shades of blue indicate cooler-than-average years, while red shows years that were hotter than average. The stark band of deep red stripes on the right-hand side of the graphic show the rapid heating of our planet in recent decades.

Start the conversation

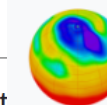
The graphics also show how no corner of the globe is immune from the effects of global warming. Stripes images for more than 200 countries, states and cities are available to download for free from the showyourstripes.info website. People in every country can see how their home is heating and share the images, helping to start conversations about climate change.

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS?



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Centre for Environmental
Data Analysis

SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY FACILITIES COUNCIL
NATURAL ENVIRONMENT RESEARCH COUNCIL

Step 3: Get the data for your chosen location

Use this tool to create your own personalised climate stripes!

It will create a PDF showing the data for a chosen UK location. You can choose the time period, how many colours to use and the latitude and longitude of your chosen location.

Example Craft Projects

Painting



Molly painted stripes showing temperature change in her local area!

Mosaic Tiles



Poppy used small tiles to create a warming stripe mosaic!

Crochet



You could also crochet an "extra" warm warming stripes scarf!



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Greta Thunberg wraps warming stripes on cover of new book: 26 May 2022

Climate Ambassadors

Climate Ambassadors is a new initiative led by the University of Reading, UKRI and STEM Learning to mobilise experts within the climate sector and support them with engaging with young people and educators.



The statement shirts making climate data fashionable at Cop26

With stripes showing temperature rise in the polar regions, the shirts are designed to start conversations about global heating



Reading Festival 2019:
Climate change research takes centre stage



music fans as rock band Enter Shikari used it as a backdrop



The outfits of the French Olympic and Paralympic teams revealed



An eco-friendly clothing range.



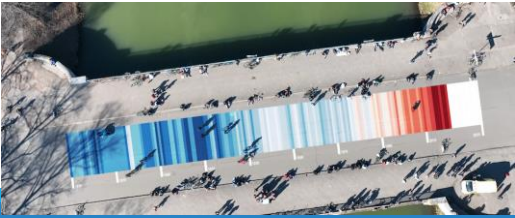
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CLIMATE CENTRAL About us Our work

Show Your Stripes Day is Happening June 21st!

Show Up for Stripes Day on June 21!

On June 21, join meteorologists, journalists, content creators, climate scientists, and cities around the world for "Show Your Stripes Day" – an event dedicated to growing global awareness about human-caused climate change.





Sustainable Fashion week



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HOW DOES IT WORK?

This is not like other fashion weeks...

SFW is community-led for community benefit. This is where **YOU** take centre stage in reclaiming your power and taking back control of how the fashion system works.

Individuals, collectives and organisations host activities all over the UK - and even further afield - all coming together in a week and more of powerful, amplified **ACTION**.

Our programme is split into the Hubs and our Community Fringe.

The Hubs are larger in scale and have multiple activities linked together

...whereas our Fringe events are smaller, one-off events & workshops.



www.sustainablefashionweek.uk/sfw-2025



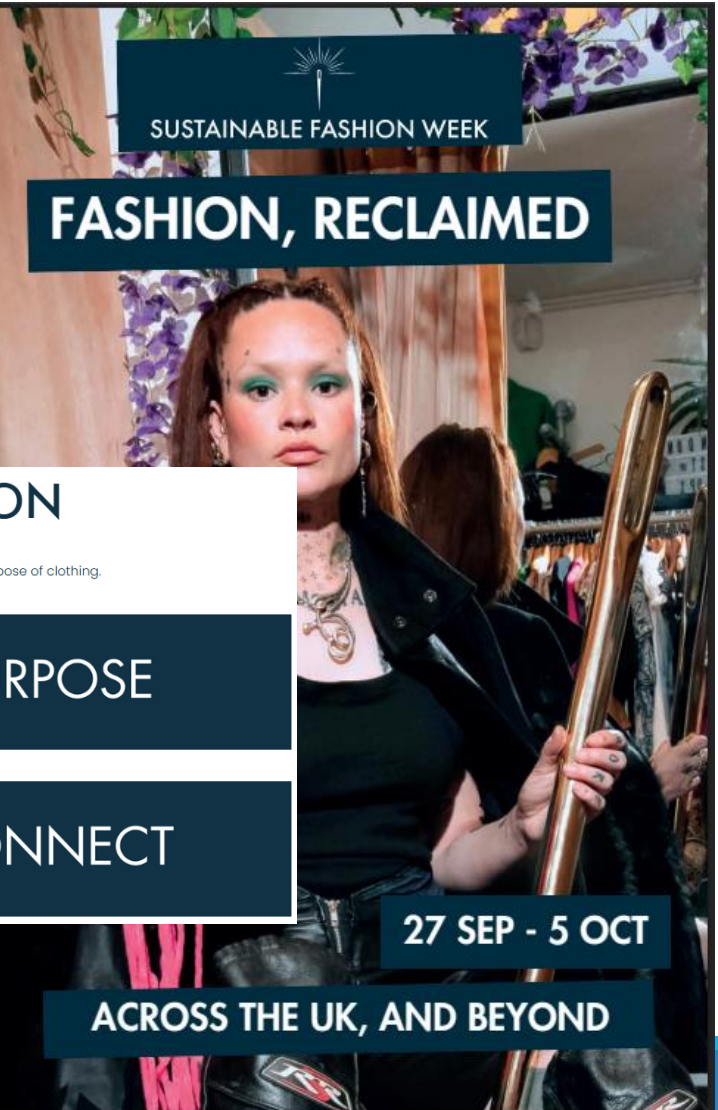
HOW DOES SFW WORK? // Page 3

THE COMMUNITY FRINGE // Pages 4-12

THE HUBS // Pages 13-48

FUTURE CITIZEN // Page 51

RECONNECTION PODCAST // Page 52



SAT 20 SEP - BIRMINGHAM

Botanical Silk Scarves Using Dyes

10am-5pm // MAC, B12

Explore eco dyeing and print techniques to create a beautifully decorated silk scarf.

29 SEP TO 5 OCT - ONLINE

Fashion Reclaimed: Shop It. It. Share It

Salvation Army Charity Shop create runway worthy outfits from our charity shop items and make your mark

OUR FOUR CALLS TO ACTION

We use our four calls to action to inspire different ways of shifting how we buy, wear, care and dispose of clothing.

REGENERATE

REPURPOSE

REWEAR

RECONNECT

TUE

Farmer & Designer Meet Up

6.30-9pm // Somer, BA1 2QZ

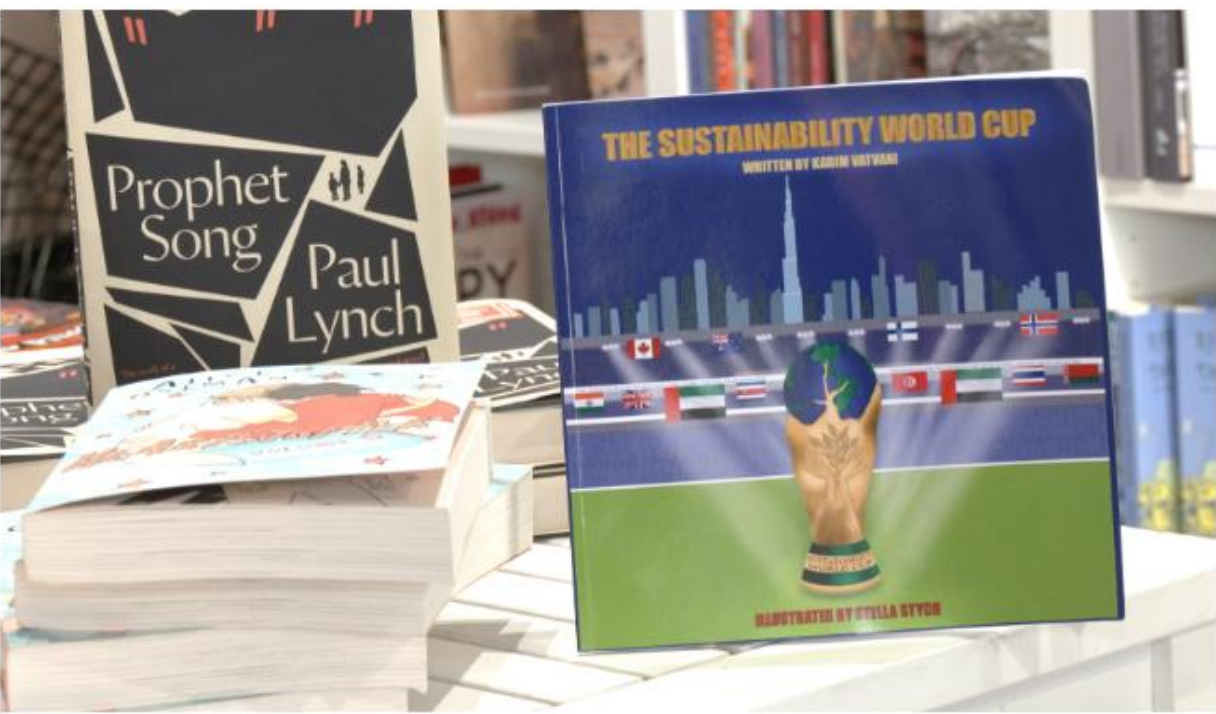
Hosted by South West England Fibreshed in continuation of last year's successful Meetup series.

< Back 23rd January 2024, 17:28

Share

Local author Karim Vatvani releases new book

Published by GBC News



Local author Karim Vatvani has released a new book.

Illustrated by Stella Stych, The Sustainability World Cup follows an international competition to find which country has the best invention to build a more sustainable future.



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All Ka

All

Grocery

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Gift Ideas

Amazon Business

Today's Deals

Browsing History

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The Sustainability World Cup Paperback – 28 Nov. 2023

by Karim Vatvani (Author), Stella Stych (Illustrator)

See all formats and editions

The Sustainability World Cup. A quadrennial event taking place across the globe. An opportunity for the World to showcase their most brilliant and amazing creations on the grandest stage of them all. The best and most inventive ideas come together as countries present their inventions in a bid to become World Champion but more importantly, to build a more sustainable future! Hosted this year by the United Arab Emirate of Dubai, which nation will rise above the rest to be crowned the winner of the Sustainability World Cup?...

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About the author

Follow authors to get new release updates, plus improved recommendations.

Karim Vatvani

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"Words are, in my not-so-humble opinion, our most inexhaustible source of magic." - Albus Dumbledore

I have always been fascinated with the World of literature but I only truly realised the power that it has to influence and shape young minds when I became a teacher. My passion for storytelling and watching my students sit on the end of their seat, as I fill their minds with fantasy and magic is a feeling like no other and is the reason why I have the best job in the World.

My dream is to write and tell stories that not only offer children an escape into a World that is entirely different from their own, but also to captivate and inspire them to be the best version of themselves and shine their light on a World that is rapidly changing and being presented with serious and ever-growing challenges.

I hope that my stories achieve this and, whether you are 1 or 100, I hope that they offer you the happiness that can only truly be enjoyed through the wonder of literature.

Education

2025/2026 Classroom Calendar

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How will today's session
influence your future practice?

ANY QUESTIONS?



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Essential Readings

Department for Education (2022) *Sustainability and climate change: a strategy for the education and children's services system*. Available at: <https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/sustainability-and-climate-change-strategy/9317e6ed-6c80-4eb9-be6d-3fcb1f232f3a#vision-and-aims> (Accessed: 12 Feb 2025).

Rawlinson, S. and Scoffham, S. (2022) *Sustainability Education: A Classroom Guide*. London, Bloomsbury Academic.



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Sustainability Education and Teacher Positionality

Our collective responsibility to teach like the planet matters!!

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